

# Live Progress Report 1 — after matches 1–2

**Date:** 2026-06-12 · **Matches recorded:** 2 of 104 · **Pipeline:** automated (v2, every 20 minutes)

## 1. Results against the locked picks

| M                 | Fixture               | Pick | Result     | Points   | E[points]   | P(outcome) | Brier         |
|-------------------|-----------------------|------|------------|----------|-------------|------------|---------------|
| 1                 | Mexico – South Africa | 1-0  | <b>2-0</b> | 1        | 1.02        | 0.672      | 0.166         |
| 2                 | South Korea – Czechia | 1-1  | <b>2-1</b> | 0        | 0.74        | 0.361      | 0.613         |
| <b>Cumulative</b> |                       |      |            | <b>1</b> | <b>1.77</b> |            | mean<br>0.389 |

Match 1 returned the predicted result with the wrong margin (one point of three). Match 2 missed: the model priced the fixture as a near-coin-flip (36/30/34) and the realistic readout settled on the draw; South Korea won it. One point against 1.77 expected is below par, on a sample of two — the running total concentrates around its expectation only over weeks, not days.

The expected-points column uses the corrected 3/2/1 expectation  $E[S] = P(\text{result}) + P(\text{result} \wedge \text{GD}) + P(\text{exact})$ . A formula error in the live pipeline’s expectation table (a stale two-tier (3,1) formula that understated every pick by ~15 percent) was found and fixed on 2026-06-12; realized points, outcome probabilities, and Brier scores were never affected.

## 2. What the results did to the forecast

Championship-level information content was 0.0011 bits (M1) and 0.0008 bits (M2) — both essentially zero, consistent with the pre-registered hypothesis that early group results barely move the title race. The champion table: Spain 27.1% → 26.9%, Argentina 18.1% → 18.3%, France 14.3% → 14.4% — all within Monte-Carlo noise of flat.

Inside Group A, however, the two results moved a great deal:

| Team         | Pts | GD | Advance (frozen → now) | Reach R16     | Reach QF      |
|--------------|-----|----|------------------------|---------------|---------------|
| Mexico       | 3   | +2 | 91.8% → <b>98.7%</b>   | 58.5% → 62.8% | 27.0% → 29.2% |
| South Korea  | 3   | +1 | 66.2% → <b>92.5%</b>   | 27.8% → 41.3% | 8.1% → 12.5%  |
| Czechia      | 0   | −1 | 68.0% → <b>50.5%</b>   | 27.0% → 18.4% | 7.1% → 4.9%   |
| South Africa | 0   | −2 | 45.6% → <b>32.5%</b>   | 8.1% → 5.3%   | 0.9% → 0.5%   |

The locked forecast had Czechia and South Korea effectively tied for the runner-up spot (68.0 vs 66.2) and named their opener as the decider; the opener has now decided it. Korea’s single win

was worth +26 points of qualification probability, because beating the direct rival is a double swing. Reality is converging on the locked finishing order — Mexico first, Korea second, Czechia advancing as a third-placer.

Spillover outside Group A is real but an order of magnitude smaller (largest moves  $\pm 1.5$  points, via the M73 routing, the third-place pool, and the T-slot draw). No champion probability moved beyond noise.

### 3. Machinery

The full automated cycle has now run end to end on real matches: PRE M1 (17:58Z, 62 min before kickoff)  $\rightarrow$  POST M1 (21:10Z)  $\rightarrow$  PRE M2 (01:31Z, 28 min before kickoff, conditioned on M1)  $\rightarrow$  POST M2 (04:14Z). One incident: GitHub’s cron scheduler went silent for three slots (02:42–04:15Z); the hold-on-doubt gate ensured nothing was lost and the POST published on the next firing. No action needed, but the pattern is worth watching — if skips recur, moving the schedule off the congested :05/:25/:45 marks is the cheap hardening.

### 4. Next up

| M | Fixture                         | Pick | E[points] |
|---|---------------------------------|------|-----------|
| 3 | Canada – Bosnia and Herzegovina | 2-1  | 0.87      |
| 4 | United States – Paraguay        | 2-1  | 0.88      |
| 8 | Qatar – Switzerland             | 1-2  | 1.06      |

Group A is idle until matchday 2 (M25 Czechia – South Africa, June 19 — now near-must-win for Czechia; M28 Mexico – South Korea, the de facto group-winner decider).

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*Generated from the live v2 records (`data/trajectory_v2.json`), the corrected expectation table (`data/match_expectations.json`), and conditioned re-simulation at  $N=30,000$ . Part of the pre-registered worldcup-prophet project; the locked forecast is unchanged at tag `prereg-2026`.*